VITyarthi :- E-Learning Platform

Digital Literacy

Project Report

Student Digital Ambassador Assignment

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Year: First Year

Course Code: CSE0001

Date: 28 March , 2026

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Introduction

This portfolio documents my work as a Student Digital Ambassador. My primary goal is to assist peers in navigating the digital landscape, from establishing professional online identities to recognizing sophisticated cyber threats. This report covers five modules: visual communication, professional portfolio building, technical collaboration, email etiquette, and cybercrime awareness. By completing these tasks, I have developed a foundational digital toolkit essential for my career in Computer Science and Engineering. The following sections detail the tools used, the resources created, and my personal reflections on each module.

Task 1 Write-up: Digital Literacy Awareness Info-graphic

For this task, I used **Canva** to design a comprehensive "Digital Literacy Awareness" info-graphic. My design focuses on four pillars: evaluating information to distinguish fake news, creating diverse digital content, understanding software/hardware, and maintaining ethical conduct. I included a dedicated section on "Safe Internet Practices," emphasizing the use of strong unique passwords, two-factor authentication (2FA), and the importance of using a VPN on public WiFi. Additionally, I highlighted productivity tools like Notion and Trello to help my batch mates stay organized. One thing I found particularly interesting during the design process was finding the right balance between visual icons and informative text. It was challenging to condense broad topics like "Digital Footprints" into actionable bullet points while keeping the layout clean and engaging. This exercise taught me how to communicate technical security concepts in a way that is accessible to a non-technical audience.

Task 2 Write-up: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

In this module, I established my professional digital presence across **GitHub**, **LinkedIn**, and **Kaggle**. On GitHub, I created a profile README documenting my branch and my academic goals as a first-year CSE student. My LinkedIn profile was updated to include my current education at VIT Bhopal, focusing on my interest in hardware and chipsets. I chose Kaggle to start engaging with the data science community, as it is a vital platform for any aspiring software engineer. Over the next four years, I plan to use these platforms as a living archive of my growth. I will use GitHub to host my coding projects, LinkedIn to network with industry professionals and seniors, and Kaggle to participate in technical competitions. Managing these accounts now ensures that when I apply for internships at companies like NVIDIA, I will have a verifiable track record of my skills and contributions. This task highlighted how a well-maintained digital footprint can serve as a powerful tool for professional advancement.

Task 3 Write-up: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

This task focused on building technical and collaborative proficiency. I used **HackerRank** to practice Python, completing beginner challenges to strengthen my coding foundation. For the collaboration component, I utilized **Google Workspace** to create a 5-question "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz". This quiz was designed to test my batch mates' knowledge of modern digital threats and professional etiquette. These tools will help me academically by providing a structured way to practice problem-solving while also enabling efficient team collaboration on group projects. Using Google Sheets to manage quiz responses showed me how data can be organized and analyzed in real-time to gain insights into peer awareness levels. Mastering these platforms is crucial for a CSE student, as they are standard in both academic settings and the global tech industry. The exercise demonstrated that digital literacy is not just about individual skill, but also about the ability to use cloud-based tools to work effectively with others in a professional ecosystem.

Task 4 Write-up: Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

I drafted two professional emails: a request for an assignment extension addressed to **Professor Manisha Jain** and an internship inquiry for **NVIDIA**. These drafts emphasize a clear subject line, formal salutations, and a concise, respectful tone. For the extension request, I explained a technical issue while showcasing my progress to maintain accountability. In the internship email, I highlighted my passion for CPU design and chipset architecture. Additionally, I created a social media checklist with 5 Do’s and 5 Don'ts, such as auditing privacy settings and avoiding emotional posting. One situation where poor communication causes problems is "flame wars" or heated online arguments. These can leave a permanent, negative trail that recruiters may find years later. To prevent this, students should follow the "Think Before You Post" rule, ensuring their digital footprint reflects professional maturity rather than impulsive reactions. Learning these nuances of online behavior is essential for protecting one's future career reputation.

Task 5 Write-up: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention

"While researching **Cyberbullying and digital safety** for this module, I was most surprised to learn how psychological manipulation, rather than technical hacking, is the primary driver of most modern cybercrimes. I found it striking that a single edited screenshot or a rushed UPI 'Request' can lead to significant financial and emotional distress for a student. As a Student Digital Ambassador, I have realized that being **'technically savvy'** is not enough; one must also be skeptical of online urgency.
As a result of this research, the one habit I will personally change is my reliance on SMS-based authentication. I have now transitioned to using dedicated Authenticator apps for all my primary accounts to mitigate the risk of SIM-swapping attacks. Furthermore, I have committed to double-checking every UPI recipient's name before authorizing any payment to prevent transaction fraud."

Conclusion

This project has been a significant step in my development as a Digital Ambassador. By moving through these five modules, I have not only improved my own technical and communication skills but also created resources that can help my peers stay safe and professional online. From mastering professional email etiquette to understanding the mechanics of Cyberbullying, I now feel better equipped to handle the responsibilities of a Computer Science student in 2026. These skills will serve as a permanent foundation for my future academic and professional career.

References

- **VITyarthi E-Learning Platform:** CSE0001 Digital Literacy Course Materials
- **Canva:** Graphic design tool for Task 1
- **GitHub/LinkedIn:** Professional networking and version control
- **National Cyber Crime Portal:** cybercrime.gov.in
- **HackerRank:** Technical skill practice platform